

Blended Learning: The Influence of Study Habits on the Academic Stress of High School Learners

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Abstract

The study's main objective is to identify how the study process influences academic stress on high school learners. Furthermore, the study also aimed to determine the academic stress level of the learners in correlation to their study habits. The researcher used a descriptive-correlation method to interpret the respondents' profiles with regard to their study habits and academic stress. The null hypothesis at a 0.05 significance level was tested to distinguish the impact of study habits on the respondents' academic stress. The multiple regression analysis measured and indicated that there is no significant influence of the learners' study habits on their academic stress.

Keywords: Blended Learning, Academic Stress, Study Habits, High School Learners, Philippines

Introduction

Schools, administrators, educators, learners, and even parents have found themselves unsuited in the remote education process due to the COVID-19 pandemic. Schools have been driven into a flow of learning that is full of complexity and restrictions as they transition from face-to-face teaching methods to the online setting that we currently are doing today (Rasmitadila, 2020). A change to the education system was made, and numerous schools, colleges, and institutions were forced to close due to the pandemic (Alqahtani & Rajkhan 2020).

Furthermore, online classes paved the way for a brand-new mode of learning (Dhawan, 2020). Online learning is a pre-existing mode of learning that is not conducted inside a classroom; it follows a more flexible environment where the learners can study in the time that they desire. Learning online paves learners' attitude of independence, which can aid them when they are learning (Hwang et al., 2020). Learners, teachers, and parents were forced to adjust to the "new normal" to create a safe environment for many. During the outbreak, e-learning became beneficial to the schools and universities in assisting the learners on learning online during the shutdown of universities and schools (Subedi et al., 2020). Schools started the implementation of the Learning Management Systems (LMS), which already existed in various schools, to assess the learners and staff in resuming the school year. Various LMS was used by schools partially as an adjustment to the modernity of the world before the pandemic and aided schools in pursuing their goal of teaching Learners despite the current situation that the

world is facing today.

With this, learning from home became the new setting for many in the Education sector since it promoted safety for the learners and staff; this also helped schools continue the school year, which was already long-awaited due to the pandemic (UNICEF, 2020). The new setting included learners creating an environment in their own homes where they can learn just like in a classroom; teachers also adjusted by creating an atmosphere wherein the learners are still motivated to learn despite being isolated and away. In today's digital age, not all learners can provide and adapt to the rapid advancements in technology (Alvarez, 2020). The new setting came with the necessary materials that were needed to have a successful school year online. With that being said, an internet connection was an essential instrument to learn.

The Philippines are ranked the 65th out of 180 countries in fixed broadband and 77th out of 137 countries in mobile as of May 2021; this is derived from the Department of Information and Communications Technology. On the report of countrywide cross-sectional research, thirty-two percent (32%) and twenty-two percent (22%) from a count of 3 670 Filipino medical learners sampled, sequentially, are struggling in adjusting to the new learning method and do not have reliable access to the internet (Baticulon et al., 2020). Learners and teachers were required to possess various and specific technological devices to assess their academic tasks. This created a problem for many since not many Filipinos can access those devices, and they struggled to manage the changes since few have the necessary

materials to attend online courses (Santos, 2020). With issues being laid out, the Department of Education (DepEd) alleviated the problems regarding the learners who do not have the necessary devices or the needed internet connection, with a solution that aided many.

DepEd's response was to launch the Basic Education Learning Continuity Plan (BE-LCP). This project ensures the safety of the teachers and personnel from the virus, the cleanliness, and safety of school facilities, certainty of the continuation of K-12 with specific adjustments as the facilities are closed for the learners, and most of all, it is launched to aid many with the continuity of education and learning amidst the ongoing epidemic. BE-LCP opted for self-learning modules that are printed for those learners who have no gadgets to use; the radio, television, and the internet were going to aid DepEd to provide quality distance learning. Schools provided their online class setting by using computers and laptops and with the help of LMS and video-conferencing tools such as Microsoft Teams, Zoom, and Google Meet. They implemented Synchronous sessions wherein all of the learners would have to attend as the teacher would be teaching; this class is designed to learn just like in a face-to-face setting. Asynchronous sessions are allocated for the teachers to provide learners with tasks that they would have to accomplish before or after the synchronous sessions. LMS sessions like these were made accessible. Even though the Department of Education had projects wherein it tried to continue education in this time of uncertainty, it still faced challenges (Barrot et al., 2021).

Meanwhile, the study conducted by Salcedo-Relucio (2019) showcased that study habits have an effect in the academic stress levels of the learners. The study used a mixed method in determining the assets affecting the high school learners' study habits. 50 learners participated using questionnaires and interviews by the researcher. The results showed that the learners who possess poor study habits have poor academic performance and have high-stress levels.. 45.83% of the learners do not study. Even though 37.50% of the learner's study, their way of studying is inefficient to attain a high mark. Hence, the study by Alnahdi et al. (2020) indicated that there is significance between the study habits and academic stress of the 50 respondents involved in the study.

In contrast to that, a study conducted by Tus (2020) indicated that the process of the learners studying, and their study habits do not affect their stress levels. The profile of 130 respondents was described using a descriptive-correlational research method. This

method included their study attitudes, study habits, and their academic achievement level. The study resulted in a mean score of 2.71; the mean that was obtained from the respondents implied a satisfactory level. A study made by Lin et al. (2020) also stipulates that there is no significance between the two factors, using a cross-sectional survey of 396 learners in Fujian, China. The results of 87.6% showed no association or link between the levels of stress and the academic performance of the respondents.

Augmenting strong study habits can pilot a learner to a favorable outcome, allowing them to work more productively while also inducing stress. Moreover, good study habits lead to a more prolific learning environment (Ebele et al., 2017). Study habits can also help with the disciplinary aspects of a learner's behavior. Thus, the researcher seeks to identify the influence of study habits on the academic stress of High school learners.

Research Questions

This study investigates the influence of study habits on the academic stress of high school learners. Specifically, it sought to answer the following questions:

1. What is the level of the learner's perceived study habits?
2. What is the level of the learner's academic stress?
3. Do the learners' study habits significantly influence their academic stress?

Literature Review

Academic Stress and Study Habits of Health Science University Learners stated a weak negative connection between the variables of academic stress and study habits (Shetty et al., 2021). However, it was not statistically significant. The study's participants were 150 undergraduate learners of various medical health departments of the university. Using the Learner Stress Inventory by Arip et al. to assess academic stress and Palsane and Sharma Study Habit Inventory (PSSHI) for the study habits. The study results stated that the learners had poor study habits and mild to moderate stress, but no indications of severe stress. They also found some significant connections between gender and study habits. Similarly, the study of Angkarini (2019) revealed that sex significantly influenced developing an effective study habit with females performing their tasks better (e.g. being more

participating during the class discussions, having the capacity to recollect material and references rapidly) than males.

With that being said, females had better study habits, which reflected on their academic performance. Singh (2019) has researched senior secondary school pupils' study patterns; he discovered no statistically significant difference in study patterns between male and female learners. However, the study of Kanchan (2017) found a significant difference between the study habits of boys and girls of secondary school learners. Yet, both studies found that female learners have better study habits than male learners (as cited by Lalhrualtuangi & Scholar, 2021). But in contrast, Bhan and Gupta (2010) revealed that sex has no significant influence on the learners in terms of study habits and academic performance (as cited by Rabie et al., 2017). Academic performance is an important feature for grade 11 and 12 learners since they are in that stage of their lives where college is near, and so they would have to make decisions that would better their academic performance so that they would have better opportunities in the future (Alyami et al., 2017).

Equally presented in the study by Alnahdi and Aftab (2020) aimed to determine the relationship between academic stress with demographic variables, study habits, and academic achievement. With 50 learners participating they found that females are experiencing more stress than males. They found a significant negative correlation between academic stress and study habits. The more academic stress a learner is experiencing, the more it can lead them to have poor study habits. Singh and Gupta (2020) represent the previous statement by saying that a learner without proper study habit cannot perform and ensure success within their academic endeavors, the learners who are experiencing ineffective study habits are the one who is prone to experience stress and anxiety.

A Turkish study using grade learners as their respondents tested the relationship between the learner's study habits, achievement, motivation, test anxiety, and efficient academic performance. Of the 510 respondents that the researcher selected, 267 were females and 243 were male and the Turkish versions of the Test Anxiety Inventory (TAI), Study Habits Inventory (SHI), and Self Evaluation Inventory (SEI) were used to collect data. Results show that females had higher scores in their success level compared to males. There was no significant difference within the subscale of worry, achievement motivation, and study habits. The intellectual achievement of grade 10 learners was determined using an analysis (Step-wise

Regression). Gender was the first variable to enter the equation, accounting for 7% of the variance in predicting GPA. Worry came in on the second stage, accounting for another 4% of the variance. Study habits came in last, accounting for another 2% of the variance. There was no link found between motivation for achievement and academic success. There was a positive relationship between test anxiety and study habits and academic success, but there was no such relationship between achievement motivation and academic success.

In contrast to Dapaynos et al (2021) which revealed that a high level of academic stress with learners indicated that they took their studies seriously, a study examining the relationship between test anxiety, study behavior, and academic achievement, Culler and Holahan (1980) discovered that high test-anxious learners performed poorly and had a higher dropout rate than low anxious learners (Culler & Holahan, 1980 cited by Ergene 2011).

Correspondingly, Maquiling (2019) examined the relationship between academic stress and study habits. Their research study focused on learners from different universities from Bahrain with 66 learners as respondents. The researcher used various research tools for their study, respectively found in Keady D's study, "All Graduate Theses and Dissertations Graduate Studies 1999 Learner Stress: An Analysis of Stress Levels Associated with Higher Education in the Social Sciences" and a questionnaire from the Office of Learner Academic Success Services, Queens' University, Kingston, Ontario Canada. Their study found that there was no significant connection between academic stress and study habits.

Similarly, a study by Ayisha, Nasla, and Sannet (2021) aimed to find the relationship between academic stress and study habits among college learners. With 40 learners participating the researcher used the Bisht Battery of Stress Scales and Study Habit Inventory by Mukhopadhyay and Sansanwal to assess the respective variables. The researcher found that there is no significant relationship between academic stress and study habits among college learners.

A study conducted by Rajesh (2019), with a total of 100 junior college learners, this study explored the influence of study habits on the stress of junior college learners. These learners were assessed with the Study Habits Inventory by Dr. BV Patel and the Reddy CJ and Reddy VS Stress Scale. They found evidence that the learners who observe poor study habits are experiencing high stress, which affects their memory,

knowledge, thinking, and learning. Similarly, a study made by Shetty et. al (2021) stated that poor study habits and frequent academic stress can bring harm to the success of learners, which can also be seen in the study of Salcedo-Relucio (2019) who claimed that the learners who do not spend much time studying and have poor study habits have lower marks than those who have good study habits. Academic stress is a learner's perceived issue. Learners experience a variety of scholastic problems, including exam stress, difficulty comprehending subjects, and changes in sleeping and eating habits. High levels of stress among learners might impair their performance and have a detrimental effect on their physical and mental health (Sahu & Jha, 2020). It was revealed in the study of Sun et al (2013) that the learners who are getting lower academic achievement are experiencing an elevated level of academic stress (as cited by Kashif et al., 2021).

A descriptive-comparative study made by Dapaynos, Butala, and Atompang entitled, *Academic Stress of Academic Track High School Learners* focused on the four strands in the institutions namely, Accountancy, Business, and Management (ABM), Science, Technology, Engineering, and Mathematics (STEM), General Academic Strand (GAS), and Humanities and Social Sciences (HUMSS). Using Yamane's formula at a margin of 0.05 margin of error, the respondents for the study were selected and determined to be High school learners.

The researcher handed out a number of 15 questionnaires to the learners of the 4 strands who they selected beforehand, this is a step in their study where they pre-surveyed their respondents to determine the academic stress of the learners. A sample of 15 respondents took the test in Cronbach's Alpha, which yielded a coefficient of 0.7348 while the Split Half Correlation yielded a coefficient of 0.7474, both showcased credibility and reliability. The study revealed a high level of academic stress among learners indicating that they took their studies seriously (Harlina et. al., 2014 cited by Dapaynos, et. al., 2021).

With this, they have a high risk of detrimental effects affecting their mental health (Eltringham, 2014 cited by Dapaynos, et. al., 2021). Academic track learners are facing significant levels of academic stress owing to difficult group mates, failed examinations or quizzes, a requirement not submitted, and teachers, according to the researcher. In a study conducted by Bataineh learners of King Saud University were academically stressed caused by being overwhelmed

with their academic tasks, they were unmotivated, and they lacked time management (Prabu, 2015 as cited by Depaynos, 2021). 26.1% of grade 11 and 12 High school learners in schools located in Tehran were suffering from stress. The root of the learners being distressed were from examinations, subject difficulty, long discussions, and their upcoming year of being in college (Shahmohammadi, 2011 as cited by Depaynos, 2021).

Anoraga (as cited by Octasya & Munawaroh, 2021) believes that stress is a person's bodily and mental reaction to a change in their surroundings that they perceive as distressing and threatening him. According to the definition stated, stress is a mental condition caused by pressure. Individuals' failure to meet their wants or desires causes this strain. This pressure may originate from within or from without.

Developing a good study habit through planning assists learners in preparing for the future and achieving academic goals. According to Bolling (2000), a lack of study habits certainly disadvantages learners and is one of the primary reasons they attend remedial classes, get behind on assignments, and eventually drop out of school which can lead to more stress (as cited by Magulod et al., 2019). According to previous research, effective study habits include studying in a quiet location, studying daily, turning off distracting devices (such as television and mobile phones), taking notes on critical content, taking frequent breaks and rests, listening to soft music, analyzing according to one's own learning style, and prioritizing difficult contents (Ebele & Olofu, 2017). One example of a bad study habit observed by many is procrastination, which is a way for learners to avoid tasks they deem undesirable (Dev, 2018). Dev (2018) also mentioned that several authors stated that stress and procrastination are factors that may negatively impact a learner's academic performance. Another example is bad time management; learners who do not have the best time management skills are the ones who are more likely to not do anything about it, though Misra and McKean (2000) proved that learners having control over their time management reduces their academic stress (as cited by Fouché, 2017).

The study of Rodrigo et al. (2021) assesses the amount of academic stress among college learners regarding personal inadequacy, fear of failure, interpersonal difficulties with professors, and insufficient learning resources COVID-19 epidemic. Their studies found that when the participants are classified by their sex, year level, and the number of hours spent learning per day, there is no found significant difference in the

level of academic stress. However, they found a considerable difference when it came to the participants being grouped by their courses. Their study also found that the majority of the learners have limited allowance for internet subscriptions and come from low-income families.

Avila et al. (2021) stated that the closing of institutions and the new mode of learning introduced difficulties with the learners and faculty members; due to this, the learners had an increased level of anxiety and academic stress. The study concluded through the respondent's response that the new mode of learning is excellent, efficient, and vital to the degrees that they are taking. However, their limited access to the needed devices for an online school affected them negatively (Avila et al., 2021).

A healthy study environment can be a factor in the gaining of productivity of learners, with the pandemic ongoing in our country, this gives learners the lack of having the right healthy study environment that may lead to more stress shortly and can hinder their success more (Garland 1994 as cited by Ehshan et al., 2018). Son et al. (2020) Indicated in their study that most learners do not have the "ideal" setup that an online mode of learning requires, challenges during e-learning such as limited access to resources (e.g., computers, laptops, tablets, stable internet connection), distractions in the environment that they are in, and at-home interruptions (i.e., the learner's responsibility out of class, chores, and family disruptions) are significant reasons for learners to be challenged during a time where they are all learning from home. These elements are likely to cause a lot of academic anxiety and worry (Clabaugh, Duque, & Fields, 2021).

Academic stress and separation from school were found to have detrimental effects on university learners' stress in one Chinese study (Yang et al., 2021), while an Irish research indicated a strong link between reported stress and the transition to online learning and assessment (O'Byrne, Gavin, Adamis et al., 2020). Learning from home has created an immense disruption to learners and parents (Chandra, 2020) though there is a study that states that the new mode of learning has been associated with a positive outcome for learners when it comes to grasping and retaining information faster (Grubic et al., 2020). Another prominent cause of increased stress among learners is the insufficiency of the learning strategy. Another prominent cause of increased stress among learners is the insufficiency of the learning strategy (Hasan & Bao, 2020).

The learners have faced a variety of obstacles due to their usage of the online learning technique, owing to their lack of expertise with it (Rasiah et al., 2020). Lastly, since there are several distractions, the Internet, when used as a learning tool, can be classified according to one's approach. Its credibility in online learning is controlled by the usage of instructors and learners (Adnan & Anwar, 2020). That is why distraction among the learners could be possible (Halupa, 2016 cited by Akpinar, 2021).

Learners sometimes consider other factors such as their environment that they perceive as out of their control to affect their success (Fouché, 2017) significantly. Equally, According to Hills (2000), a learner's learning environment can affect their academic performance. If one has an environment that positively impacts their way of studying, it could reflect on their performance and vice versa.

Represented in the study of AlAteeq et al. (2020), they assessed during the coronavirus outbreak the socio-demographic variables and the feelings and concerns of the participants. Their findings determined that more than half of the respondents were under moderate stress, while the other half were under severe stress. In comparison to intermediate and secondary school pupils, university learners had a substantially higher mean score of perceived stress. Though more than half of them experienced moderate levels of stress, the other half experienced high levels of stress.

Adolescence is a time where various changes occur in an individual's body and life, from being immature to mature, with drastic changes in their physical body, mental state, and how they would interact with others (Dahl, 2004 cited by Depaynos et al., 2021). A number of learners experienced maturing during their year in junior high school, though not all of them would undergo these changes up until they reach their year in High school. With this, to aid learners with their future challenges, it is crucial to be knowledgeable regarding the academic stress level of High school learners.

Methodology

The research employed a descriptive correlation design to understand the relationship between variables. The data gathered by the researcher will not be controlled or manipulated; they will only be observed and measuring them (McCombes, 2019). Employing research designs helps the researcher analyze and reach reliable results. A correlation research design helps the researcher understand the relationships

between the variables without being manipulated. The data gathered can also show negative and positive correlations (Bhandari, 2021). Through this research method, the researcher can determine the influence of study habits on the academic stress of high school learners.

Respondents of the Study

The respondents of the study were high school learners. Thus, during the process of this research, there was a global pandemic, and human contact is limited, hence the convenience sampling technique will be utilized where the respondents chosen to participate are only chosen because they were the most accessible during the process of making this study, was chosen (McCombes, 2019). The research respondents will cater to participants who meet the criteria.

Instrument of the Study

This research administered two instruments to assess the influence of study habits to the academic stress of high school learners. The instrument used to measure the learners' academic stress is the Perceived Stress Scale (PSS-14). This instrument was developed by Cohen, Kamarch, and Mermelstein in 1983. It was used in Anuradha et al. (2017) study entitled Stress and Stressors among Medical Undergraduate Learners: A Cross-sectional Study in a College in Tamil Nadu. This scale consists of fourteen (14) questions pertaining to the respondents' feelings and thoughts during the last month. A five-point Likert Scale was used in the instrument which is: zero for never, one for almost never, two for sometimes, three for fairly often, and four for very often. According to Huang et al. (2020), the Cronbach's Alpha reliability of the PSS-14 is 0.083. The instrument that will observe High school learners' attitudes towards their studies and study habits is the Study Habits Questionnaire (SHQ). This instrument was developed by Olutola, Olatoyem, and Olatoye in 2016 and used in their study entitled Assessment of Social Media Utilization and Study Habit of Learners of Tertiary Institutions in Katsina State. This questionnaire consists of twelve (12) questions about respondents' attitudes towards their studies and study habits. A four-point Likert Scale was used in the instrument: one for strongly agree, two for agree, three for disagree, and four for strongly disagree. According to Olutola et al. (2018), the Cronbach's Alpha reliability of the Study Habits Questionnaire (SHQ) is 0.81.

Ethical Considerations

Besides gathering the data and information needed for the study, the researcher emphasized ensuring the respondents' safety and rights throughout the data gathering process. The researcher obtained authorization from their research advisor before distributing the questionnaires for the data collection procedures and tools utilized in their study. After that, the participants were informed of the study's primary objectives. The researcher's and respondents' rights will be maintained by adhering to ethical research principles throughout this investigation. Furthermore, the researcher conducted the study in accordance with Republic Act 10173, commonly referred to as the Data Privacy Act of 2012. This legislation thereby safeguards the fundamental human right to privacy and communication while promoting progress through sharing of information.

Data Gathering Process

In determining the influence of study habits on the academic stress of high school learners, the researcher would have to answer the questions constructed within the study. The collection of data would be done with the use of two instruments for both of the variables. The learners' academic stress would be measured using The Perceived Stress Scale (PSS-14) and the study habits of the participants would be determined using the Study Habits Questionnaire (SHQ).

To ensure the reliability and honesty of the responders, an instruction noting this matter would be located in the instructions of the instrument, a statement regarding the questionnaire being confidential would also be included. Once the questionnaire has been planned out, Google form is the online software the researcher deems fit to be used because of its convenience. It enables the researcher to gather the results since there are restrictions brought by the epidemic that we are currently in.

Once the researcher gathers the questionnaires, they would interpret the data. In this process, the discovery and identification of the relationship between the two variables would occur. With that being said, the data collected through gathering would aid the researcher with the analyses and interpretations throughout the study.

Results and Discussion

This section indicates the presentation, analysis, and interpretation of the results from the gathered data.

Level of the Learner's perceived Study Habits

Table 1 holds data in regards to learners' perceived Study Habits. It was evaluated by the Study Habits Questionnaire (SHQ). In the first indicator, the mean score attained the lowest verbal interpretation with 2.08 as its mean score, meaning that the learners who do their assigned tasks on time are of low rate. The respondents attained a low mean score of 2.08 - 2.48.

Table 1. Level of the Learner's Perceived Study Habits

	Indicators	Mean	Verbal Interpretation
1.	I always do my assignments on time.	2.08	Low
2.	I always read my books even if there is no exam.	2.74	High
3.	I read my book every day.	2.83	High
4.	I go through my books after every lesson.	2.61	High
5.	I am always ahead of my teacher	2.90	High
6.	I always have group discussions with my colleagues.	2.48	Low
7.	I have a personal time table which I try to follow.	2.25	Low
8.	I am not easily distracted by friends when it is time to study.	2.58	High
9.	When I miss anything while copying notes, I try to correct it immediately after the class.	2.16	Low
10.	I am easily distracted by noise or radio when it is time to study.	2.18	Low
11.	I try to read other materials to get more information on the topics taught in the class.	2.16	Low
12.	I read my class work during holiday period.	2.63	High
	Total	2.35	Low

Particularly, based on the given data, the respondents often have group discussions with their colleagues, have a personal timetable that they follow, correct and edit their notes after class discussions, get easily distracted by noise during their time of studying, and read more literary works in order to gain more information regarding the class.

According to a study by Aquino (2011) with 313 respondents and the majority of it, 295 of the respondents got a low mean in terms of their study habits which they were observed to be low achievers compared to the high achievers' mean score, which resulted in a high mean. Thus, this implies that high achievers have a better grasp of their study habits than low achievers (as cited by Digal et al., 2019).

Level of the Learner's Academic Stress

Table 2 presents the data of the respondent's academic stress data evaluated by The Perceived Stress Scale (PSS-14), which indicates that they have a high mean score of 2 - 3. It conveys that learners have a high-stress level in accordance with their academics and other factors during an online setup course. The

learners deal with academic-related issues and personal matters such as family, events, personal issues, etc. They felt that the stress and anxiety they feel are repressing and happening more so often. The learners included in this study have low mean scores of 2.10 - 2.46.

Table 2. Level of the Learner's Academic Stress

	Indicators	Mean	Verbal Interpretation
1.	In the last month, how often have you been upset because of something that happened unexpectedly?	2.66	High
2.	In the last month, how often have you felt that you were unable to control the important things in life?	2.61	High
3.	In the last month, how often have you felt nervous and "stressed"?	2.93	High
4.	In the last month, how often have you dealt successfully with irritating life hassles?	2.64	High
5.	In the last month, how often have you felt that you were effectively coping with important changes that were occurring in your life?	2.60	High
6.	In the last month, how often have you felt confident about your ability to handle your personal problems?	2.46	Low
7.	In the last month, how often have you felt that things were going your way?	2.19	Low
8.	In the last month, how often have you found that you could not cope with all the things that you had to do?	2.38	Low
9.	In the last month, how often have you been able to control irritations in your life?	2.34	Low
10.	In the last month, how often have you felt that you were on top of things?	2.10	Low
11.	In the last month, how often have you been angered because of things that happened that were outside of your control?	2.40	Low
12.	In the last month, how often have you found yourself thinking about things that you have to accomplish?	2.98	High
13.	In the last month, how often have you been able to control the way you spend your time?	2.40	Low
14.	In the last month, how often have you felt difficulties were piling up so high that you could not overcome them?	2.60	High
	Total	2.63	High

Meanwhile, the data also shows that the respondents face difficulties in their academics which hits the study with an average mean score between 2.60 - 2.98, which is high. It indicates that learners' difficulties are affected by matters in their personal lives and how they could not overcome them.

Overall, the data has shown that the participants have a general mean score of 2.63 which is considered high, this depicts that there are high levels of academic stress the learners face during COVID-19. The findings in this disclose that the learners are stressed in the COVID-19 setting of online courses, alongside other factors that can increase stress levels (Clabaugh, 2021).

Influence of Study Habits on Academic Stress

Table 3. *Results of the Regression Analysis*

<i>Variables</i>	<i>Unstandardized Coefficients</i>		<i>Standardized Coefficients</i>	<i>T</i>	<i>Sig.</i>
	<i>B</i>	<i>Std. Error</i>	<i>Beta</i>		
(Constant)	32.337	2.936		11.012	.000
<i>Study Habits</i>	.099	.097	.083	1.021	.309

** Regression analysis is not significant at 0.05 level

Results of the statistical analysis in Table 3 reveal that study habits ($B = .09$) do not significantly affect the level of academic stress among the learners. Therefore, the null hypothesis is accepted.

A study made by Thanseera and Nasla (2021) found no significance between the two. They conducted the study with 40 learners that are in college and collected the data using M. Mukhopadhyay and D.N Sansanwal's BishtStudy Habit Inventory (2011).

Similarly, another study by Maquiling (2019) attained the data of the same result wherein there is no significance between the learners' academic stress levels and their study habits. Maquiling determined their study by observing a few universities in the Kingdom of Bahrain with 66 learners. In one study where 150 undergraduate medical health university learners, Shetty et. al (2021) found a weak negative connection between the two variables (i.e., academic stress and study habits) though there was no found significance.

Conclusion

Poor study habits can often lead learners to be academically stressed. While in the presence of the COVID-19 pandemic where learners have shifted to online learning education at the safety of their homes, managing ones time, ensuring of a proper learning environment, discipline and control must be improved and strengthened.

The researcher have established that this study will explain how parents can determine the influence of their child's study habits on their academic stress in school, and providing adequate space and assistance for their child to reduce the academic stress they encounter. A proper and healthy learning environment is beneficial for a child to study in. Better understanding of the academic stress that learners experience will help school administrators, instructors, institutions, and guidance counselors will lead them to provide and form a focused plan for the learners. In this way, it will aid the learners on the difficulties they

come across in the setting of a pandemic, decreasing possible academic stress that learners may encounter. This study will also benefit learners on finding out how they can cope and deal with academic stress while experiencing adolescence. Lessening the pressure they come across while facing the day-to-day life of being an adolescent learner. As this study has been conducted while under a pandemic, there could be more that haven't been looked into. Future researcher may benefit from this study on determining how they may be able to discover more influences that lead to academic stress. This would imply that there is more to study on the matter, and there will be more to discover.

Following an in-depth evaluation of the research outcome as well as discussion among researcher, the following recommendations are proposed: For the learners, the researcher recommend that they consider taking the time to dedicate a certain hour into their routine to go over their lessons and revise them as they please for them to better comprehend the lessons they partake in and may partake in the future. Specifically, the researcher propose the "One hour a day is a leap for learner-kind!", where stated before encourage learners to go out of their way to choose and ample amount of time in their daily routine for them to focus themselves in enhancing their learning ability and routine, for example, learner's during this hour can scan through their notes and clarify missing points, do their tasks, study future topics beforehand to get a better grasp on discussion and have good-participation during class, and many more that they can do during this hour. This project also encourages learners to have a better timetable for their lifestyle which can give them more time to do leisure activities as much as they like. In conclusion, this project allows learners to manage their tasks efficiently as well as enjoy themselves doing it.

Meanwhile, the school administrators, guidance counselors, and teachers, the researcher advise that they should take a proactive approach to reach out to learners and allow them to have a safe space to express their grievances and help them find healthy ways to cope with these grievances. The researcher suggest creating a certain club or organization for learners to be able to have a group discussion and relate to each other and with the help of school administrators, guidance counselors, and teachers create a plan for learners to lessen their academic stress. One instance this can be beneficial is when an ample amount of learners went through a grueling week, holding a group discussion about that grueling week and having them participate in enjoying activities after can help them de-stress and enjoy the rest that came with the

hard work they have done, which can be named as “No man is an island” since this project encourages relatability towards learners and school administrators, guidance counselors, and teachers and help them build a healthy and safe relationship.

Moreover, the future researcher to identify other variables that may have an influence on a learner’s academic stress and investigate the ideas of this study and provide more information as a reference for future researchers that have a similar topic.

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